

Winter Consulting

Capstone Project for Winter Consulting ' 2025

Consulting & Analytics Club, IIT Guwahati

CASE 2 – Viewer Retention in OTT Platforms: Diagnosing Engagement Patterns

Context

A leading OTT streaming platform produces and distributes original television series across multiple genres. While the platform consistently achieves strong viewership at launch, it faces a persistent business challenge:

A significant proportion of viewers disengage during Season 1, limiting user lifetime value and complicating content renewal decisions.

Internal teams suspect that episode-level content design choices such as pacing, cognitive load, and episode structure may be contributing to early viewer drop-off. However, the platform currently lacks a clear, data-backed understanding of which factors matter most.

To address this gap, the platform has shared internal episode-level engagement data with a consulting team for analysis

The Business Problem

The platform seeks to answer three core questions:

1. Why do viewers drop off?
 2. Which factors have the greatest impact on drop-off risk?
 3. What changes can be made, at the content or product level to reduce drop-off without compromising creative quality?
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About the Dataset

The dataset contains episode-level viewing, behavioral, and content attributes of multiple series on an OTT platform. It captures how episodes differ in design, how viewers interact with them during playback, and the resulting engagement outcomes.

Link for the dataset – [DATASET](#)

Your Role

You are engaged as a consultant to help the platform diagnose the root causes of early viewer drop-off and recommend actionable solutions.

Participants are expected to:

- Use the data to identify and validate problems
- Avoid assumptions not supported by analysis

Key Questions to Address

Participants are expected to use the provided dataset to address the following:

1. What patterns or relationships in the data explain differences in viewer continuation across the episodes?
2. Can episodes be meaningfully segmented based on content characteristics and viewer behavior, and how do these segments differ in engagement outcomes?
3. Based on your analysis, what actions (if any) should the platform consider to improve the performance, and why?

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Solution Design

Based on their findings, participants should propose **practical and implementable** recommendations that address the issues identified through analysis.

Recommendations may include (but are not limited to):

- Changes to episode structuring or sequencing
- Product-level interventions to support viewer understanding or continuity
- Targeted actions for specific episode or content segments

All proposed solutions must:

- Be clearly linked to insights derived from the data
- Be feasible within the context of an existing OTT platform

Prioritization and Risk Mitigation

Participants should recognize that not all recommended actions can be implemented at the same time.

They are expected to:

- Prioritize recommendations based on potential impact and feasibility, clearly justifying why certain actions are chosen over others
- Identify key risks associated with the chosen actions and propose practical mitigation measures to manage these risks

Deliverables

Participants are required to submit a presentation of **up to 7 slides**, excluding the title slide and appendix.

The 7 slides should clearly cover the problem understanding, data-driven insights, segmentation (if any), conclusions, recommended actions, prioritization, and risk considerations.

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Evaluation Criteria

Submissions will be evaluated based on:

- Depth and quality of data analysis
- Clarity of problem diagnosis
- Strength and logic of recommendations
- Feasibility of proposed solutions
- Ability to clearly link insights to actions